

Sociology is a western discipline that originated in France, after French Revolution, emerged as a response to the significant societal changes brought about by French Revolution.

→ French Revolution (1789) :-

- Political Developments
 - It resulted in the overthrow of absolute monarchy and the establishment of republic.
- | | | |
|-------------------------------|---|--|
| <u>Monarchy</u> | ↔ | <u>Republic</u> |
| → Subject | | → Citizen (Rights and Duties) |
| → Fully controlled by monarch | | → Individual Rights |
| → No individual Rights | | <div style="display: flex; align-items: center;"> <div style="text-align: center; margin-right: 10px;"> <u>Individual</u>
↙ </div> <div style="text-align: center; margin-right: 10px;">↘</div> <div style="text-align: center;"> <u>State</u>
 <u>Social Contract</u> </div> </div> |

- Resulted in expansion of state's role to guarantee individual rights, e.g. issuance of certificates for birth, date, marriage, protection of property and inheritance rights, etc.

Sociology emerged to study community and its impact on group identity and social institutions.

→ Industrial Revolution (1700's) :

- Economic Impacts / Developments
- Technological advancements and growth of industrial production.



Increased Efficiency, mass production



Search for new markets and raw materials

- The system of profit led to rise of capitalism.
- To get new markets and raw material Europeans led to explore Asia and Africa as traders around 1757.
- Colonialism started as a result of revolution and Europeans established political relationship with India around 1858.

As a result of colonialism, British travellers, scholars and administrators came to India and started documenting their observations and interpretations of our society, which we call as proto-sociologists.

e.g. Megasthenes

Seven classes of Indian Society as seen by him

- Philosophers
- Animal husbanders
- Traders and laborers
- Warriors or Soldiers
- Inspectors
- Hunters
- Counselors and Assessors

Highlights caste system

Al-Biruni (Arab Traveller)

Four division of society.

- Brahmins
- Kshatriyas
- Vaishyas
- Shudras

Mughal Accounts (Ain-i-Akbari) by Abul Fazal

- also provide insights into the caste system, revenue, administration and economic structure of that time.

- It also highlights a sense of continuity in Indian society.

Example: Daroga (have origins in Mughal era).

Caste:

Given by Duarte Babosa, a portuguese traveller who arrived in Kerala, Malabar coast, also known as cosmopolitan city at that time.



It was a hub for trade with various communities like Arabs, Syrian Christians and Jews, etc.

British Colonial's three approaches to study Indian Society:

- Orientalist
- Utilitarian
- Missionary

1. Orientalist Approach:-

- Led by British Elite Scholars who translated Sanskrit and Persian scriptures.
- They gave a "textual" view which allowed persistence of upper caste Brahminical views despite the fact that political power was in non-Brahmin hands.

→ Contradictions

- Indian society reduced to caste.

- Periodized Indian history into 'Hindu', 'Muslim' and 'Christian' periods.
- Based on textual view.
- Perpetuated status quo :- (Maintained Indian culture as static, main dominated by caste hierarchies, overlooking social transformations.)
- Maintained western ~~to~~ superiority and positioned Indian traditions in relation to this perceived superiority.

Critique of Orientalism: India

- Reinforces, the idea of [^] being basically upper caste (Hindus), which led invisibilization of other practices.
- Equated Indian Society to Hindu Society, ignornoring other groups, regional variations.
- Louis Dumont → Homo hierarchicus

